

Chapter 166-2

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In the end, Liang Shi agreed.

For someone like Lu Jiayi, even if you couldn't be friends with her, it was best not to make her an enemy.

Plus, she was now Xu Qingzhu's business partner.

When Lu Jiayi called her that, she was probably reminding Liang Shi.

They were purely business partners, and there would be future dealings between them. The goodwill extended to Liang Shi was essentially "love the house, love the crow."¹

If she really declined, it would make Liang Shi seem ungrateful and could also affect Lu Jiayi's cooperation with Xu Qingzhu.

Liang Shi didn't want her own emotions to affect Xu Qingzhu.

The place they went to was a roast duck restaurant—a location Liang Shi had specifically chosen.

Considering that Lu Jiayi was from the capital, she chose a restaurant that was known for doing capital-style cuisine well. It was a way of catering to her preferences.

After the roast duck arrived, Lu Jiayi elegantly put on gloves, personally rolled one up, and then handed it to Liang Shi.

Liang Shi: "?"

"You eat it," Liang Shi said. "I can do it myself."

"Consider it my apology to you," Lu Jiayi said.

Liang Shi's brow furrowed slightly. "Did you do something wrong?"

"I'd like to know what I did wrong too." Lu Jiayi placed the rolled duck on Liang Shi's plate, then continued rolling with her head lowered, her voice also low. "Maybe I was just born with a face that people don't like?"

There was a hint of self-deprecation in her words.

Liang Shi was taken aback.

But she had to admit, Lu Jiayi's duck rolls really were beautifully made.

While Liang Shi was thinking about how to answer her question, Lu Jiayi had already changed the subject. "What made you think of coming here for roast duck? Did you investigate me in private?"

"Why would I investigate you?" Liang Shi ate the duck roll she had made, and only after swallowing did she say, "Your accent is very obvious."

Lu Jiayi: "I see."

This meal wasn't exactly comfortable for either of them, but at least Liang Shi was full.

When it came time to pay, Lu Jiayi was one step ahead. When the cashier handed the card back, Lu Jiayi raised it with a wave. "Consider it me trying to please my business partner."

Liang Shi was momentarily speechless.

Lu Jiayi seemed to really like the term "business partner." She always used it when mentioning Xu Qingzhu.

After the meal, Liang Shi was about to leave when she heard Lu Jiayi say, "Do you have anything to do this afternoon? There's a shooting range nearby. Want to go play?"

Liang Shi didn't understand her intentions, but under her sincere gaze, she slowly nodded.

Shooting was one of Liang Shi's hobbies and also a way for her to relieve stress.

She usually went to shooting ranges on her own, but since coming here, she hadn't had time to go.

When she and Lu Jiayi stood together, Lu Jiayi suddenly asked, "Want to compete?"

Liang Shi: "Compete in what?"

"Shooting, of course." Lu Jiayi laughed. "How are you so adorably clueless?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi had been called clueless before, but perhaps because of her good looks, people would add "adorably" when calling her that, making it sound friendly.

But here, "adorably clueless" wasn't commonly used to describe Alphas.

Still, Liang Shi didn't dwell on it. She raised her arm, held the gun in a standard posture, aimed at the bullseye, and pulled the trigger without warning.

Even with the silencer, you could still hear the sound of the bullet cutting through the air.

"Thud!"

Nine rings.

Lu Jiayi curved her lips. "Not bad."

She then turned to face her own target.

—Ten rings.

Afterward, Liang Shi also hit several ten-ring shots, but she wasn't as good as Lu Jiayi.

Lu Jiayi hit the bullseye almost every time.

It was just that her preparation time was very long—it took her twice as long as Liang Shi to take each shot.

In the end, naturally, Lu Jiayi won.

The continuous shooting made Liang Shi's palms a bit numb. She shook out her hands and admitted defeat graciously. "I lost."

Then she put down the gun and went to the rest area nearby.

Lu Jiayi followed. When she came over, she handed Liang Shi a bottle of water. After taking a few sips and screwing the cap back on, Liang Shi asked, "What do you want? Go ahead and say it."

"Can you satisfy anything?" Lu Jiayi asked in return.

"Not Xu Qingzhu," Liang Shi said.

Lu Jiayi: "..."

After a moment, Lu Jiayi leaned back in the lounge chair and laughed. "This is the first time I've seen someone make a bet without determining the stakes beforehand."

Liang Shi looked at her. "This is my first time making this kind of bet too."

"Aren't you afraid I'll make some unreasonable demand?"

"Why should I be afraid?"

"Oh?"

Liang Shi paused, then shrugged indifferently. "You can make any request you want. Whether I do it or not is up to me."

Hearing this, Lu Jiayi nodded slowly. "Interesting."

The atmosphere fell into silence.

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1. "爱屋及乌" (ài wū jí wū): A Chinese idiom literally meaning "love the house, love the crow (on its roof)." It means that when you love someone, you extend that love to everything associated with them. ↵